10-MINUTE DAILY ROUTINE FOR SENIORS

Fall-Proof Legs Protocol

Strengthen your legs, improve your balance and stay independent at home.

Chair-based · Safe for all levels



Stronger legs

Better balance

Safer at home

Only 10 min a day

START HERE

How This Protocol Works

Ten minutes a day. Simple moves done in a chair, at the kitchen counter or by the wall. No gym, no heavy weights.

YOUR 3 PHASES

WEEKS 1–2 • GENTLE

Start with exercises 01 to 10. Learn the moves and build confidence.

WEEKS 3–4 • ACTIVE

Add exercises 11 to 25. More strength, more balance.

WEEK 5 AND BEYOND • CHALLENGE

Mix in exercises 26 to 35 and keep going every day.



YOUR DAILY 10 MINUTES

1. Warm up with Seated March (01).
2. Pick 4 exercises from your phase.
3. Finish with 1 balance exercise and a deep breath.

SAFETY RULES

- Always use a sturdy chair, a counter or a wall for support.
- Wear non-slip shoes.
- Stop if you feel pain, dizziness or shortness of breath.
- Talk to your doctor before starting a new exercise routine.

FOR CAREGIVERS

Why the Best Caregivers Use This Protocol

Families don't just want someone to keep Mom company. They want someone who keeps her strong, steady and safe.

BECOME THE SPECIALIST

Fall prevention is the most valued skill in senior care. This protocol gives you a clear, daily routine to lead.

SHOW REAL RESULTS

Track progress every week. When families see their loved one standing up alone again, they understand your value.

EARN WHAT YOU DESERVE

Caregivers who offer specialized care can confidently ask for a higher hourly rate and win more referrals.



From 'the person who stays with Mom' to 'the professional who keeps her on her feet.'

WARM-UP

01 Seated March

Wake up the legs and get the blood flowing.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





Start



Lift



Switch

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall near the front of the chair.
2. Lift one knee, then lower it.
3. Alternate legs at a steady pace.

GOAL: Warm up hips and legs

POSITION: Seated

EQUIPMENT: Sturdy chair

DOSE

1 minute

Make it easier: Lift the heels only, keep toes on the floor.

Make it harder: Swing the arms as you march.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your back away from the chair and breathe normally.

02 Seated Knee Extension

Build the thigh muscles that help you stand and walk.

STRENGTH • LOWER BODY

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





Start · Straighten · Lower Slowly

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall, hands on the sides of the seat.
2. Straighten one knee until the leg is level.
3. Hold 2 seconds, then lower slowly.

GOAL: Thigh strength

POSITION: Seated

EQUIPMENT: Chair

DOSE

10 each leg

Make it easier: Straighten only halfway.

Make it harder: Hold for 5 seconds at the top.

SAFETY FIRST: Move slowly. Do not lock the knee hard.

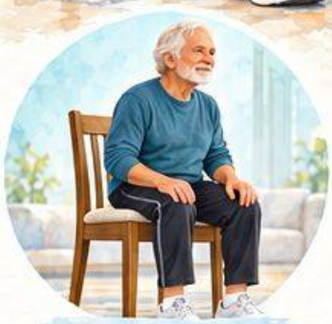
03 | STRENGTH • LOWER BODY

Sit-to-Stand

The most important exercise for getting up on your own.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE

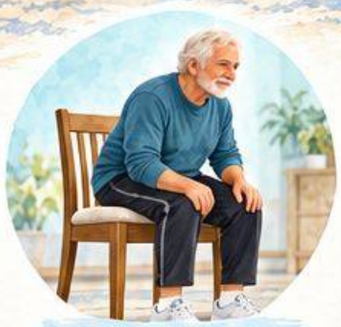




Start



Lean & Stand



Sit Slowly

STEP BY STEP

1. Scoot to the front of the chair, feet hip-width apart.
2. Lean forward and stand up, using your legs.
3. Sit back down slowly, with control.

GOAL: Leg and hip power

POSITION: Seated to standing

EQUIPMENT: Sturdy chair against a wall

DOSE

5 to 10
repetitions

Make it easier: Use your hands on the armrests to help.

Make it harder: Cross your arms over your chest.

SAFETY FIRST: Place the chair against a wall so it cannot slide.

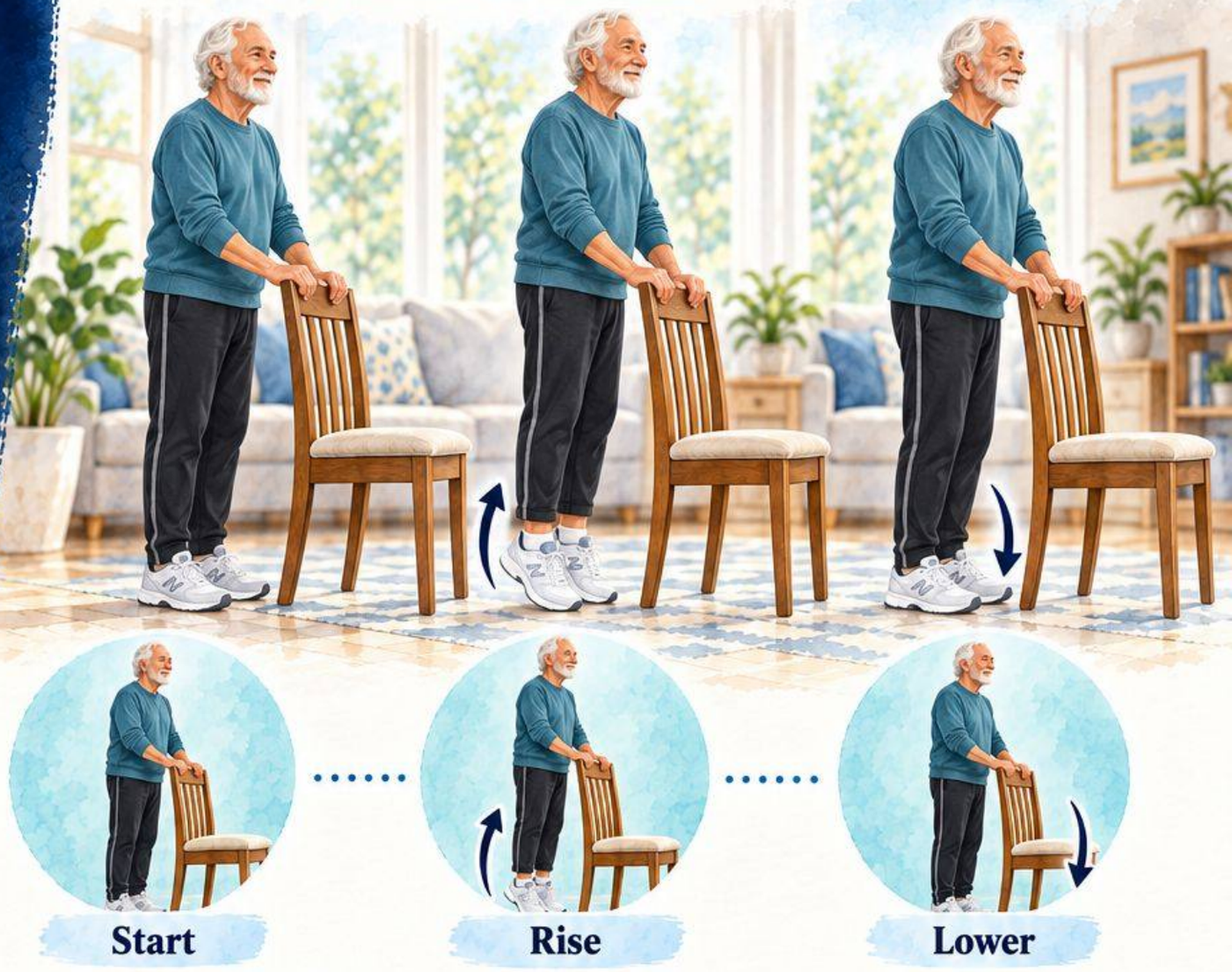
04

STRENGTH • ANKLES

Heel Raises

Strong calves keep your steps steady.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Start

Rise

Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand behind the chair, holding the back.
2. Rise up onto your toes.
3. Lower your heels slowly.

GOAL: Calf and ankle strength

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair back

DOSE

10 to 15 repetitions

Make it easier: Do it sitting down.

Make it harder: Hold with one hand only.

SAFETY FIRST: Always keep a hand on the chair.

05

STRENGTH • ANKLES

Toe Raises

Lift the toes to stop tripping and dragging the feet.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Start · Lift Toes · Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall with feet flat on the floor.
2. Keep heels down and lift your toes.
3. Lower slowly and repeat.

GOAL: Shin strength, prevent tripping

POSITION: Seated

EQUIPMENT: Chair

DOSE

15 repetitions

Make it easier: One foot at a time.

Make it harder: Do it standing, holding the chair.

SAFETY FIRST: Wear non-slip shoes.

06

STRENGTH • HIPS

Side Leg Raise

Strong hips keep you from tipping sideways.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





STEP BY STEP

1. Stand tall next to the chair, holding it.
2. Lift the outside leg out to the side.
3. Return slowly. Switch sides.

GOAL: Hip and side balance strength

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair back

DOSE

8 to 10
each side

Make it easier: Smaller movement, toes touching the floor.

Make it harder: Hold the leg out for 3 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your body upright, do not lean.

07

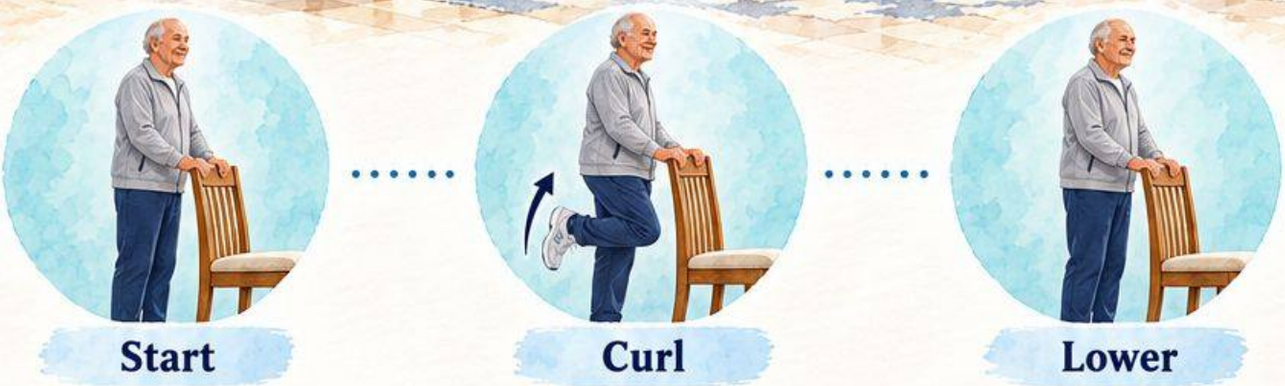
STRENGTH • HIPS

Standing Leg Curl

Strengthen the back of the legs for safer walking.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Start Curl Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand behind the chair, holding the back.
2. Bend one knee, bringing the heel up behind you.
3. Lower slowly. Switch legs.

GOAL: Hamstring strength

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair back

DOSE

10 each leg

Make it easier: Lift the heel only a little.

Make it harder: Pause 2 seconds at the top.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep both knees close together.

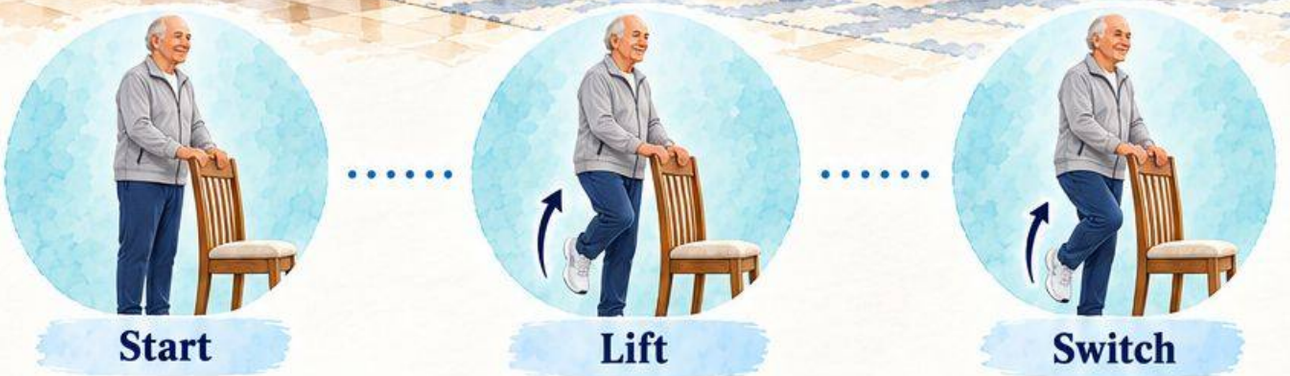
BALANCE

08 Supported Single-Leg Stand

Train the balance you need on stairs and in the shower.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





STEP BY STEP

1. Stand behind the chair, both hands on the back.
2. Lift one foot slightly and hold.
3. Lower and switch legs.

GOAL: Standing balance

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair back

DOSE

Hold 10 seconds, 3 times each leg

Make it easier: Keep the toes touching the floor.

Make it harder: Hold with one finger only.

SAFETY FIRST: Stop if you feel dizzy.

09 | BALANCE

Heel-to-Toe Walk

Walk a straight line to steady every step.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Start · Step · Continue

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand beside a wall with one hand on it.
2. Place one heel right in front of the other toes.
3. Take 10 slow steps forward.

GOAL: Walking balance

POSITION: Standing, along a wall

EQUIPMENT: A wall or kitchen counter

DOSE

10 steps, 2 times

Make it easier: Leave a small gap between the feet.

Make it harder: Look straight ahead, not at your feet.

SAFETY FIRST: Clear the floor of rugs and objects first.

10

BALANCE • COORDINATION

Clock Taps

Step in every direction, the way real life asks you to.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Start



Tap Forward



Tap Side & Back

STEP BY STEP

1. Imagine you stand in the middle of a clock.
2. Tap one foot to 12, then 3, then 6.
3. Return to center each time. Switch legs.

GOAL: Reaction and balance

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair back

DOSE

5 rounds each leg

Make it easier: Only tap forward and to the side.

Make it harder: Call out the numbers faster.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep a hand on the chair the whole time.

STRENGTH

11 Ball Squeeze

Wake up the inner thighs that keep your knees steady.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





Place | Squeeze | Release

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall and place the ball between your knees.
2. Squeeze for 5 seconds.
3. Relax slowly and repeat.

GOAL: Hip and inner thigh strength

POSITION: Seated to standing

EQUIPMENT: Chair and soft ball

DOSE

10 squeezes

Make it easier: use a pillow instead of a ball.

Make it harder: hold for 10 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Breathe out as you squeeze. Never hold your breath.

12

• FLEXIBILITY

Seated Toe Reach

Reach for your toes to keep the backs of the legs supple.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE



Sit tall

Reach

Return

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit near the front of the chair with one leg straight, heel on the floor.
2. Slide your hands down toward your toes.
3. Hold, then sit back up slowly.

GOAL: Leg flexibility

POSITION: Seated

EQUIPMENT: Strap or towel

DOSE

Hold 15 seconds, 3 times each leg

Make it easier: reach only to the knee.

Make it harder: loop a strap around the foot and pull gently.

SAFETY FIRST: Stretch only to a gentle pull, never to pain.

13 • STRENGTH

Band Leg Press

Push like you are climbing stairs, with a resistance band.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Bend



Press



Return

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall and loop the band around one foot.
2. Bring the knee in, then press the leg straight out.
3. Return slowly against the band.

GOAL: Leg and hip strength

POSITION: Seated with support

EQUIPMENT: Resistance band

DOSE

10 each leg

Make it easier: use a lighter band.

Make it harder: pause 3 seconds with the leg straight.

SAFETY FIRST: Hold the band firmly so it cannot snap back.

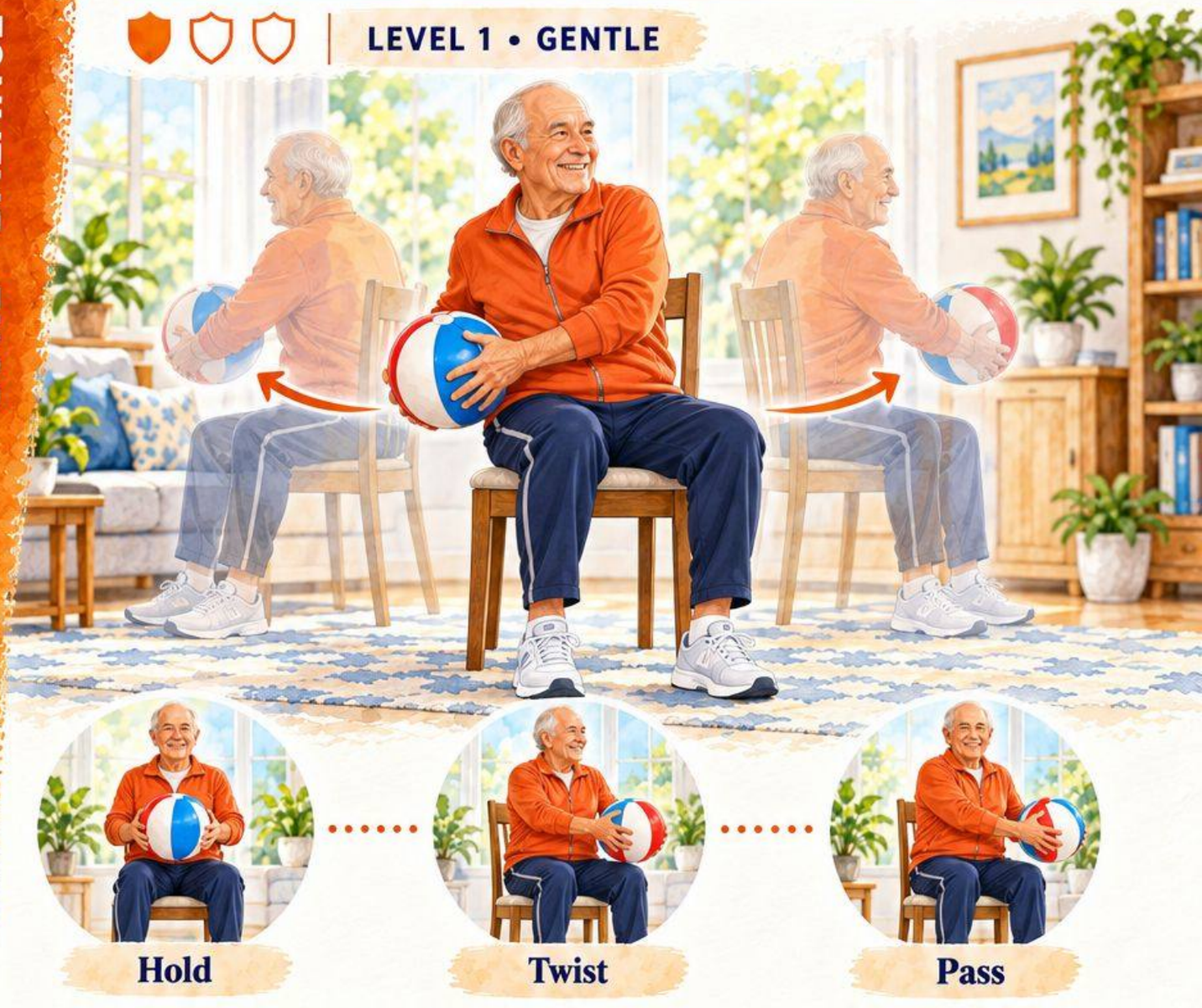
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CORE • BALANCE

Ball Pass Twist

A strong core is the secret behind good balance.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Hold

Twist

Pass

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall holding the ball in front of you.
2. Turn gently to one side and pass the ball to the other hand.
3. Turn the other way and keep passing.

GOAL: Core and balance strength

POSITION: Seated to standing

EQUIPMENT: Sturdy chair and a ball

DOSE

10 passes each way

Make it easier: just turn, without passing.

Make it harder: lift the feet slightly off the floor.

SAFETY FIRST: Turn from the waist, slowly. Keep your feet planted.

15 • BALANCE

Sideways Steps

Step sideways to stay steady when you turn or move around furniture.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE



Start

Step out

Bring together

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand facing the kitchen counter, hands on it.
2. Step sideways onto the next floor marker.
3. Bring the other foot next to it and continue.

GOAL: Hip and side balance strength

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Floor markers and a counter

DOSE

10
steps each way

Make it easier: take smaller steps.

Make it harder: hold the counter with one hand only.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your toes pointing forward and your hands on the counter.

16 Ankle Weight Knee Lift

Add a little weight to build real walking strength.

• STRENGTH

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Seated



Lift knee



Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Strap the weights on and sit tall.
2. Lift one knee up toward your chest.
3. Lower slowly and switch legs.

GOAL: Leg and hip strength

POSITION: Seated to standing

EQUIPMENT: Chair and ankle weights

DOSE

10
each leg

Make it easier: do it without weights.

Make it harder: hold the knee up for 3 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Start with a light weight, 1 to 2 pounds.

17

STRENGTH • BALANCE

Step Taps

Lift your feet higher so you never catch a toe on a step.

LEVEL 3 • CHALLENGE



Stand

Tap

Return

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand in front of the low step, one hand on the chair.
2. Lift one foot and tap the top of the step.
3. Bring it back down and switch feet.

GOAL: Hip and leg strength

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Low step and chair

DOSE

10 taps each foot

Make it easier: tap a thick book instead.

Make it harder: tap faster, still holding the chair.

SAFETY FIRST: Use a low, non-slip step. Always keep a hand on the chair.

18

BALANCE • COORDINATION

Reach & Tap Cones

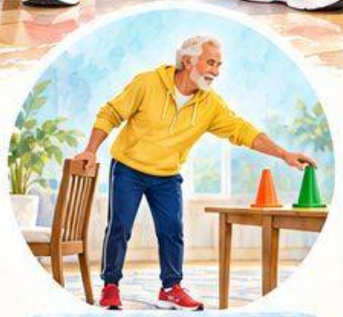
Reach in every direction, the way real life asks you to.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Stand



Reach



Tap

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand beside the chair, holding it with one hand.
2. Reach and tap the top of each cone.
3. Return to center and switch hands.

GOAL: Balance and coordination

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair and cones

DOSE

3 rounds each hand

Make it easier: move the cones closer.

Make it harder: call out each color as you tap.

SAFETY FIRST: Reach only as far as feels steady.

19

BALANCE

Backward Walk

Practice stepping back safely, for those moments you need to move away.

LEVEL 3 • CHALLENGE



Start

Step back

Continue

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand at the counter, one hand on it.
2. Step backward, placing the toe down first.
3. Take 10 slow steps back along the line.

GOAL: Balance and confidence

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Counter and floor tape

DOSE

10 steps, 2 times

Make it easier: take very small steps.

Make it harder: walk back without looking down.

SAFETY FIRST: Clear the path first and keep a hand on the counter.

20 Partner Ball Toss

Catch, balance and laugh together: the perfect final challenge.

BALANCE • COORDINATION

LEVEL 3 • CHALLENGE





Ready | Toss | Catch

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand next to your chair, one hand on it, facing your partner.
2. Toss the soft ball gently underhand.
3. Catch it with one hand and toss it back.

GOAL: Balance and coordination

POSITION: Standing with support

EQUIPMENT: Chair and soft ball

DOSE

20 tosses

Make it easier: sit down and toss.

Make it harder: stand with feet close together.

SAFETY FIRST: Use a soft ball and stand close to each other.

21

STRENGTH • LOWER BODY

Kitchen Counter Mini Squats

Small squats with the kitchen sink as your support.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Stand tall



Sit back



Stand up

STEP BY STEP

1. Face the counter, hands on the edge, feet hip-width apart.
2. Bend the knees a little, pushing the hips back.
3. Stand up tall, squeezing the buttocks.

GOAL: Leg and hip strength

POSITION: Standing at counter

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

10 squats

Make it easier: bend only a little.

Make it harder: hold 3 seconds at the bottom.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your knees behind your toes and your hands on the counter.

22

WARM-UP • BALANCE

Counter Marching

March in place while holding the counter.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Stand

Lift knee

Switch

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand at the counter, both hands on it.
2. Lift one knee toward the ceiling.
3. Lower it and lift the other. Keep a steady rhythm.

GOAL: Warm-up and balance

POSITION: Standing at counter

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

1 minute

Make it easier: lift only the heels.

Make it harder: hold the counter with one hand.

SAFETY FIRST: Look forward, not down at your feet.

23

STRENGTH • THIGHS

Sofa Leg Lifts

Strong thighs, right from your favorite sofa.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Sit tall

Lift

Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit at the front of the sofa with your back straight.
2. Straighten one leg and lift it a few inches.
3. Hold 3 seconds, then lower slowly.

GOAL: Thigh strength

POSITION: Seated on sofa

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

8
each leg

Make it easier: lift without holding.

Make it harder: hold for 5 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Choose a firm sofa, not a soft one that sinks.

24

STRENGTH • ARMS

Wall Push-Ups

Strong arms help you catch yourself and get up from the floor.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE







Arms straight



Lean in



Push back

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand an arm's length from the wall, hands at shoulder height.
2. Bend your elbows and bring the chest toward the wall.
3. Push back to straight arms.

GOAL: Arm and chest strength

POSITION: Standing at wall

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

10
push-ups

Make it easier: stand closer to the wall.

Make it harder: step a little farther back.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your feet flat and your body in a straight line.

25 | FLEXIBILITY • CALVES

Wall Calf Stretch

Loose calves mean longer, steadier steps.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





Step back



Lean



Hold

STEP BY STEP

1. Place both hands on the wall.
2. Step one foot back, heel on the floor.
3. Lean gently forward until you feel a stretch in the back leg.

GOAL: Calf flexibility

POSITION: Standing at wall

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

Hold 20 seconds, 2 times each leg

Make it easier: shorter step back.

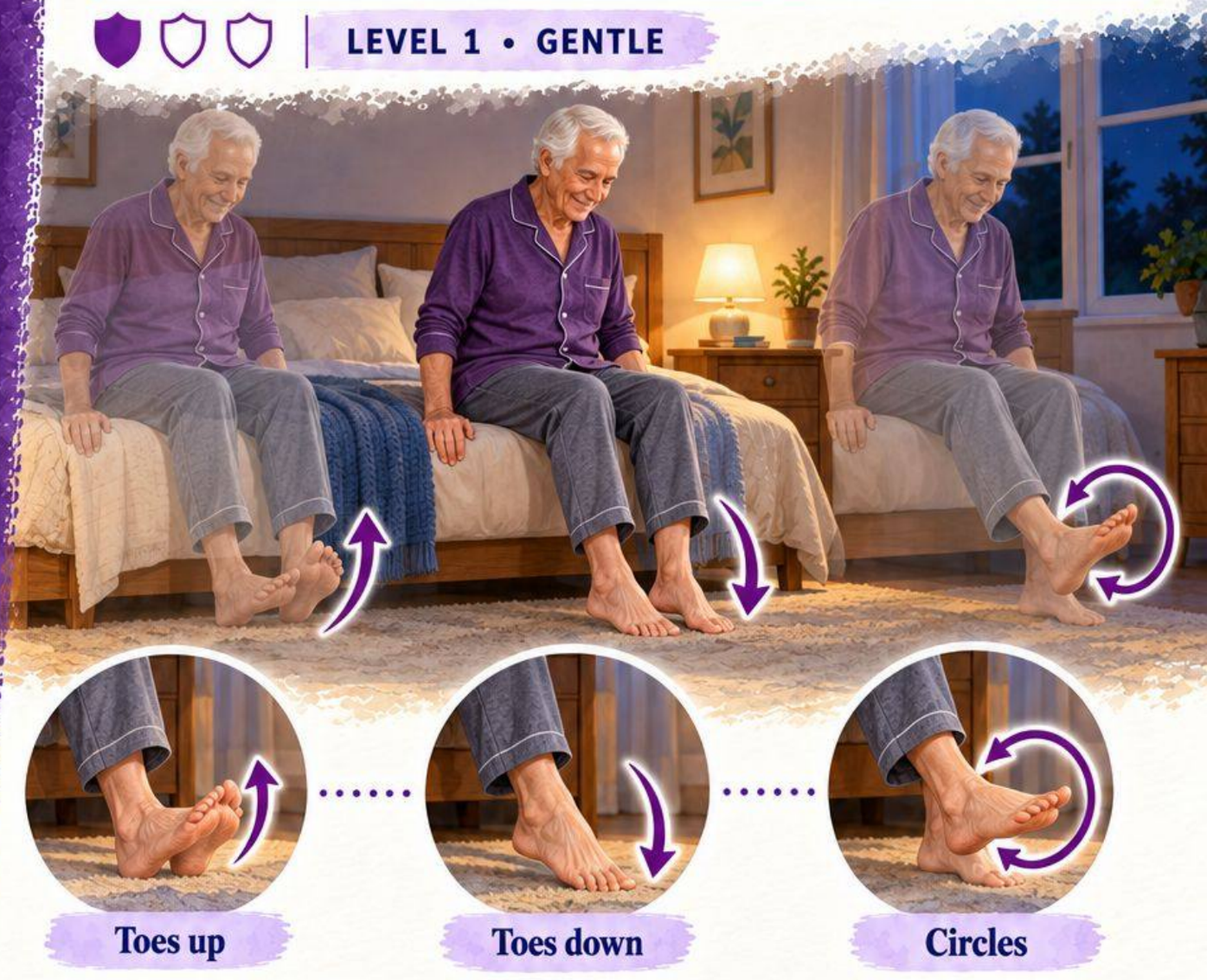
Make it harder: bend the back knee slightly.

SAFETY FIRST: Never bounce. Stretch only to a gentle pull.

Bedside Ankle Pumps

Wake up your legs before you stand up at night.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Toes up

Toes down

Circles

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit on the edge of the bed, feet flat on the floor.
2. Pull your toes up, then point them down.
3. Draw 5 slow circles with each foot, then stand up slowly.

GOAL: Circulation and safe standing

POSITION: Seated at bedside

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

10 pumps + 5 circles each foot

Make it easier: one foot at a time.

Make it harder: lift the foot a little while circling.

SAFETY FIRST: Turn on the light and wait 30 seconds before standing up.

27

STRENGTH • HIPS

Counter Hip Extension

Strong glutes push you forward and keep you upright.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE



Stand

Leg back

Return

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand tall at the counter, both hands on it.
2. Move one straight leg back a few inches.
3. Squeeze, then bring it back slowly. Switch legs.

GOAL: Hip and glute strength

POSITION: Standing at counter

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

10
each leg

Make it easier: a smaller movement.

Make it harder: hold 3 seconds at the back.

SAFETY FIRST: Do not lean forward. Keep your back straight.

28 | • BALANCE

Counter Weight Shifts

Learn to move your weight safely in every direction.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE



Center

Shift side

Shift front

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand at the counter, feet hip-width apart.
2. Shift your weight slowly to the right foot, then the left.
3. Shift forward onto your toes, then back onto your heels.

GOAL: Balance and weight transfer

POSITION: Standing at counter

EQUIPMENT: No equipment

DOSE

10 shifts each direction

Make it easier: very small movements.

Make it harder: hold each shift for 3 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep both feet on the floor the whole time.

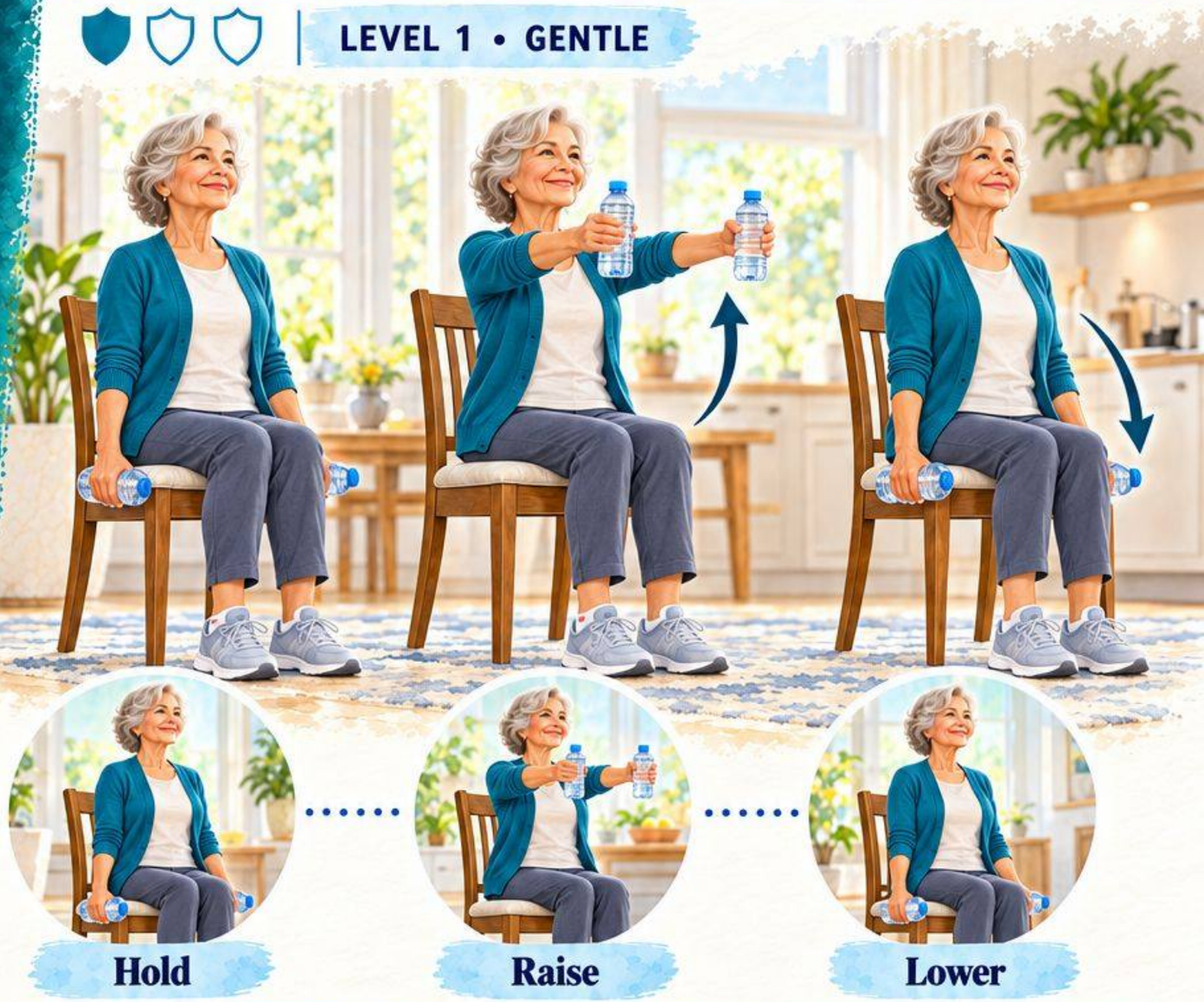
29

STRENGTH • ARMS

Water Bottle Arm Raises

Two water bottles become your first set of weights.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Hold Raise Lower

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall, a bottle in each hand.
2. Raise both arms forward to shoulder height.
3. Lower them slowly.

GOAL: Arm and shoulder strength

POSITION: Seated on chair

EQUIPMENT: Two water bottles

DOSE

10 raises

Make it easier: empty bottles.

Make it harder: full bottles.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your shoulders relaxed and breathe out as you lift.

30

STRENGTH • FEET

Towel Toe Scrunches

Strong toes and feet grip the floor better.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Feet on towel

Scrunch

Release

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit with your bare feet on a towel.
2. Curl your toes to pull the towel toward you.
3. Relax and repeat.

GOAL: Foot and toe strength

POSITION: Seated with bare feet

EQUIPMENT: Kitchen towel

DOSE

10

scrunches each foot

Make it easier: both feet together.

Make it harder: put a book on the far end of the towel.

SAFETY FIRST: Do this seated only, never standing on the towel.

STRENGTH • BACK

31 Seated Towel Row

Sit taller and protect your back with a simple towel.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE



Hold Pull Release

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall and wrap the towel around your feet.
2. Pull the ends toward your waist, squeezing your shoulder blades.
3. Release slowly.

GOAL: Back and posture strength

POSITION: Seated on chair

EQUIPMENT: Bath towel

DOSE

10 rows

Make it easier: pull gently.

Make it harder: hold the squeeze 3 seconds.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep your back straight, do not lean back.

32

STRENGTH • HIPS

Paper Plate Slides

Slide your feet to strengthen the hips and inner thighs.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE



Feet together

Slide out

Slide in

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit tall with a paper plate under each foot.
2. Slide both feet out to the sides.
3. Slide them back together.

GOAL: Hip and inner thigh strength

POSITION: Seated on chair

EQUIPMENT: Two paper plates

DOSE

12 slides

Make it easier: one foot at a time.

Make it harder: slide forward and back too.

SAFETY FIRST: Use smooth floors only and stay seated.

33 | • BALANCE

Rolled Towel Step-Overs

Practice lifting your feet over things, like a rug or a step.

LEVEL 3 • CHALLENGE



Stand

Step over

Step back

STEP BY STEP

1. Stand at the counter with the rolled towel beside you.
2. Lift one foot and step over the towel.
3. Bring the other foot over, then step back.

GOAL: Balance and foot clearance

POSITION: Standing at counter

EQUIPMENT: Rolled bath towel

DOSE

8 step-overs each side

Make it easier: use a flat towel.

Make it harder: lift the knee higher.

SAFETY FIRST: Keep one hand on the counter at all times.

34

STRENGTH • LOWER BODY

Cushion Sit-to-Stand

A cushion makes standing up easier while you build strength.

LEVEL 1 • GENTLE





Seated



Lean & stand



Sit slowly

STEP BY STEP

1. Place a firm cushion on the chair seat.
2. Lean forward and stand up using your legs.
3. Sit back down slowly. Remove the cushion when it feels easy.

GOAL: Leg and hip strength

POSITION: Seated to standing

EQUIPMENT: Chair and firm cushion

DOSE

5 to 8
repetitions

Make it easier: use two cushions.

Make it harder: no cushion.

SAFETY FIRST: Put the chair against the wall so it cannot slide.

35 | • COORDINATION

Kitchen Towel Toss

Toss, reach and catch: a fun way to train quick reactions.

LEVEL 2 • ACTIVE





Ready · Toss · Catch

STEP BY STEP

1. Sit facing your partner.
2. Toss the rolled towel gently underhand.
3. Catch it with one or two hands and toss it back.

GOAL: Coordination and reaction speed

POSITION: Seated facing partner

EQUIPMENT: Rolled kitchen towel

DOSE

20 tosses

Make it easier: hand it over instead of tossing.

Make it harder: catch with one hand.

SAFETY FIRST: Stay seated and reach only as far as feels steady.

Great job! Repeat your daily 10 minutes and watch your legs get stronger.